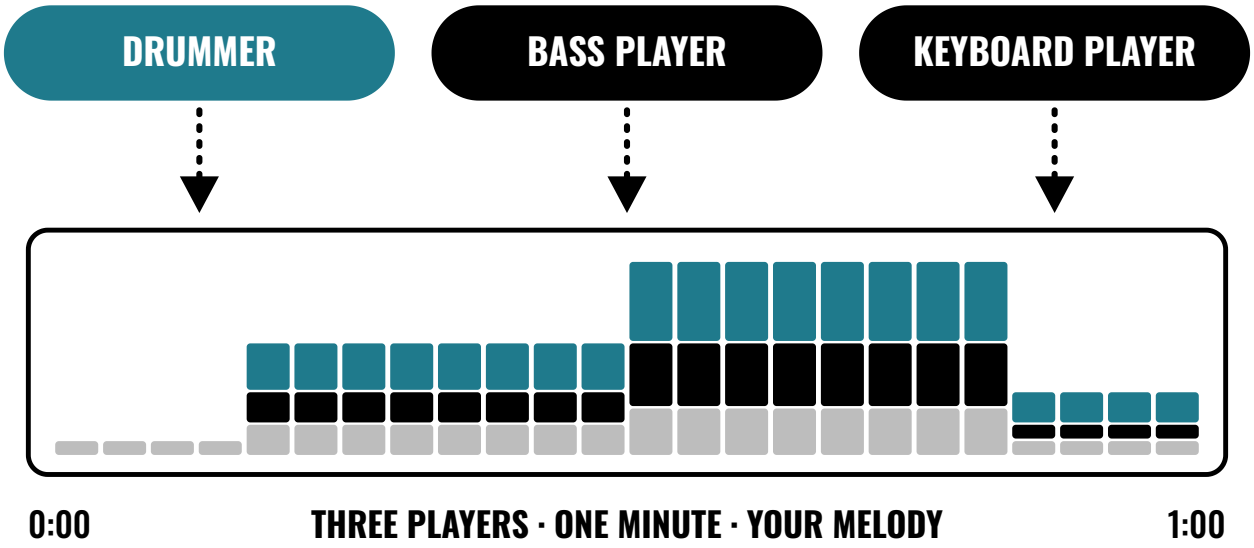
HUDSON BEAT



BUILD A BAND WITHOUT THE BAND
SESSION PLAYER'S STUDIO

DMP2 · arrangement · intro slides

GRADES 9–12 · 7 CLASS PERIODS · 25 PAGES + 19-SLIDE DECK

SESSION PLAYER'S STUDIO

How to use this resource

START HERE

Teacher

WHAT THIS IS ·

A 7-class-period structured project for high school music technology. Each student builds a one-minute, live-style band arrangement in Logic with three Session Players: Drummer, Bass Player and Keyboard Player. They choose a chord progression, customize each player's style, groove and complexity, arrange an intro, groove section and ending, add an original melody, mix it, and present it with Padlet questions for feedback. It is the project from my Digital Music Production 2 course (type: structured; focus: arrangement), and the projects in that course can be taught in any order.

QUICK START ·

1. Read the pacing guide (page 5) and my teacher notes (pages 6–7).
2. Set up the Presentation Padlet and open Logic to try the three players (page 4).
3. Print the student pages (pages 13–24), one set per student.
4. Open the intro deck and read the speaker notes for Class 1.

THE INTRO DECK ·

Every slide has a class: Class 1 (slides 1–8), Class 2 (slides 9–10), Class 3 (slides 11–13), Class 4 (slide 14), Class 5 (slide 15), Class 6 (slides 16–17) and Class 7 (slides 18–19). Every slide has speaker notes.

Fonts: the deck uses Oswald and Source Sans 3 (free on Google Fonts, built into Google Slides). If PowerPoint or Keynote shows a different font, install the two fonts or present the PDF copy, which shows the intended look.

WHAT'S INSIDE ·

PART	PAGES	USE
Teacher pages	pages 2–12	How to use, overview, setup, pacing, teacher notes, what changed, Logic quick reference, Easier and Harder variations, worked example (2 pages)
Student pages	pages 13–24	Chord cheat sheet, Players sheet, Arrangement plan, Melody planner, Mix sheet, project sheet (3 pages), rubric, vocabulary, feedback planner, reflection
Intro deck (separate file)	deck	19 slides, .pptx + PDF, speaker notes on every slide

NO AUDIO INCLUDED

No audio, video, songs, artists or albums are named or included. Students make every sound in their tracks themselves, from the Session Players, instruments and sounds in Logic.

MAKE IT FIT YOUR CLASS ·

- **Easier or harder:** my variations on page 6: a given chord progression, or an original progression, a B-section and a live-recorded element (both laid out on page 10).
- **Feedback board:** my sheets use Padlet for the three questions; any class board works.
- **Chords:** students choose their own progression; the cheat sheet (page 13) is there when they are stuck.
- **Grading:** my rubric, /25, the average of the student's and your score (page 21).

IN ONE SENTENCE

Students learn that a band is a set of choices, and that the player makes the notes while they choose the sound.

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SESSION PLAYER'S STUDIO

Project overview

OVERVIEW

DMP2 · Structured

FROM MY DMP2 PROJECT MENU

Session Player's Studio · Structured · Arrangement

Build a realistic band performance using Logic's Session Players. Customize groove, complexity, and add your own melody.

WHAT STUDENTS MAKE ·

One original, live-style production about one minute long. Three Session Players (Drummer, Bass Player and Keyboard Player) play a chord progression the student chooses, each with its own style, groove and complexity. The piece has a clear intro, groove section and ending, with the energy varied between sections, and the student's own melody on top. It is mixed with EQ and effects. They hand in a bounced .mp3 or .wav and the zipped .logicx project, plus a Padlet post with three feedback questions, then present the piece.

WHAT THIS PROJECT REINFORCES ·

Teaches arrangement, harmonic thinking, and how to build a full production with limited manual input. Great for students who struggle with playing instruments.

STANDARDS ·

Supports the National Core Arts Standards for Music (Music Technology, high school): generating and developing ideas (MU:Cr1.1, MU:Cr2.1), presenting work (MU:Pr6.1) and responding to it (MU:Re7.2).

GOALS ·

- Learn to use Logic's Session Players (Drummer, Bass, Keyboard)
- Adjust style, groove, and complexity to create a realistic performance
- Arrange a short piece with an intro, groove, and ending
- Add an original melody and mix for a polished final product

AT A GLANCE ·

Grades	9–12: the second-year course, after a first year of Logic Pro basics
Length	7 class periods: set up and chords, customize, three working days, mix and bounce, present
Software	Logic Pro: Session Players (Drummer, Bass Player, Keyboard Player), arrangement, EQ and effects, bounce
You supply	Macs with a current Logic Pro, headphones, a feedback board and a place to submit files
Assessment	My rubric, 5 categories scored 1–5, /25; final grade = average of the student's and the teacher's score (page 21)

BEFORE THEY START

Students should already know how to open a project, add software instruments, use the Mixer, and save, bounce and zip in Logic. Nobody needs to read music or play an instrument.

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SESSION PLAYER'S STUDIO

Setup and what to watch

SETUP

Teacher

YOU NEED ·

- **A Mac with a current Logic Pro** for each student, and **headphones**. Session Players are part of recent versions of Logic Pro, so check yours before Class 1.
- **A place to submit** the .mp3 or .wav and the zipped .logicx (your class page).
- **The Presentation Padlet**, set up before Class 1 (yours to set up; none is included).
- **The Chord cheat sheet**, printed (page 13).
- **Printed student pages**, one set each (pages 13–24).

BEFORE CLASS 1 ·

- [ ] Set up the Presentation Padlet in your class page.
- [ ] Open Logic on a student computer and load Drummer, Bass Player and Keyboard Player.
- [ ] Choose the two YouTube videos you might show (my resources, page 7).
- [ ] Decide how you will treat the live-recorded element in the Harder variation (page 10).

WHAT TO WATCH (MY STRUGGLES) ·

Students leave everything on default, the melody is an afterthought, sections sound the same, and chord progressions intimidate some students. This is a great project for students who are less confident with playing but have strong arrangement ideas.

KIT SUGGESTIONS, NOT PART OF MY SHEETS

- Ask while students work: what did you change on this player? How is your intro different from your peak?
- Have students play the same four chords with three different drum settings and say which feels like which section.
- Give the melody a class of its own (Class 4), as my second struggle suggests.

ORIGINAL WORK ·

A KIT SUGGESTION

Students may borrow a chord progression (step 2) but not a melody or a recording. They write their own melody and hand in only their own track.

KEEP THE VOLUME MODERATE

A full band in headphones can get loud. Tell students to start low and to check the final mix at a normal level.

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SESSION PLAYER'S STUDIO

Pacing guide · 7 class periods

PACING

Teacher

7 class periods, as on my project menu. The "My plan" column is my day-by-day pacing guide as I wrote it; the other columns show what to put on the screen and in students' hands.

CLASS	MY PLAN	TEACHER MOVES	DECK	STUDENT PAGES
CLASS 1	**Class 1:** Introduction. Demo Session Players. Students set up and choose chord progressions.	Slides 1–8: hook, what the project is, the five steps, five words to know, steps 1 and 2 and a four-bar chord loop. Hand out the project sheet, the Chord cheat sheet and the Players sheet. Demo the three players, then check that each student has a chord progression before they leave.	Slides 1–8	p. 13, p. 14, p. 18, p. 19, p. 20, p. 22
CLASS 2	**Class 2:** Customize session players. Begin arranging sections.	Slides 9–10: step 3, customize, and the same players with different settings. Students fill in the Players sheet, then start on the Arrangement plan.	Slides 9–10	p. 14, p. 15
CLASS 3	**Classes 3–5:** Working days — arrange, add melody, refine.	Slides 11–13: step 4, how the energy changes over one minute, and the worked example on paper. Then work time on the Arrangement plan.	Slides 11–13	p. 15, p. 11, p. 12
CLASS 4		Slide 14: step 5, the melody. Hand out the Melody planner. Dedicate time to melody only, then work time.	Slide 14	p. 16
CLASS 5		Slide 15: step 6, mix. Hand out the Mix sheet. Ask each student to play their intro and then their peak, and say what changed.	Slide 15	p. 17
CLASS 6	**Class 6:** Final mix, bounce. Prepare presentations.	Slides 16–17: what to turn in and the rubric. Students bounce, name their files and post their three Padlet questions.	Slides 16–17	p. 21, p. 23
CLASS 7	**Class 7:** Presentations with Padlet Q&A peer feedback.	Slides 18–19: presentation day and the close. Every student presents and answers 2 of each classmate's questions. Reflection (page 24) follows the presentations.	Slides 18–19	p. 23, p. 24

THE ONE THING TO DO ON CLASS 1

Open Logic, load all three players and press play on the same four chords. Then change one setting live and ask what changed. Students need to see that the player makes the notes and they choose the sound.

CLASSES 3–5

Working days; Classes 4 and 5 have one slide each. Ask: how is your intro different from your peak?

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WHAT THIS PROJECT REINFORCES ·

Teaches arrangement, harmonic thinking, and how to build a full production with limited manual input. Great for students who struggle with playing instruments.

COMMON STUDENT STRUGGLES ·

- Students leave everything on default settings. Push them to customize style, groove, and complexity.
- The melody is an afterthought. Dedicate time specifically to melody writing.
- Students don't vary sections — the whole track sounds the same. Show them how to change Drummer patterns and Bass complexity per section.
- Chord progressions intimidate some students. Provide a cheat sheet of common progressions.

SUGGESTED VARIATIONS ·

Easier: Provide a chord progression and let students focus on arrangement and melody.

More Advanced: Require an original chord progression, a B-section with a different groove, and at least one live-recorded element.

WHERE THIS KIT HELPS WITH EACH STRUGGLE

- Default settings: the Players sheet (page 14) asks for a style, groove and complexity for every player.
- An afterthought melody: Class 4 and the Melody planner (page 16) give it a class of its own.
- Sections that sound the same: slide 12 and the Arrangement plan (page 15), with the worked example (page 12).
- Chords that intimidate: the Chord cheat sheet (page 13), in five keys.

WHERE THIS KIT HELPS WITH THE VARIATIONS (KIT SUGGESTION)

- Easier: a given progression and a section plan to fill in (page 10).
- More advanced: planning pages for an original progression, a B-section and a live-recorded element (page 10).

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SUGGESTED RESOURCES ·

MY LIST	IN THIS KIT
A YouTube video on setting up Session Players in Logic Pro, step by step	Kept as I wrote it, but not included, linked or titled: it is someone else's video. Choose one to show on Class 1; the Players sheet (page 14) is where students write down what they set.
A YouTube video on what Logic's new Session Players can do	Kept as I wrote it, but not included, linked or titled. Pair it with the worked example (pages 11–12) to show how the settings change a section.
Common chord progressions cheat sheet	This kit supplies one: the Chord cheat sheet (page 13), made from music theory in five major keys with no song named.

HOW TO GRADE ·

- My rubric: five categories, each scored 1–5, /25 (page 21). Students score themselves first; the final grade is the average of their score and yours.

Suggestions from this kit, not part of my rubric:

- Creativity & Originality: are style, groove and complexity set on purpose, or left on default (my first struggle)? The melody is where the student's own ideas show.
- Technical Skill: open the project. Are three Session Players loaded with custom settings (Players sheet, page 14), and are EQ and effects really in use?
- Composition & Structure: compare the piece with the Arrangement plan (page 15). Does the intro feel different from the peak (my third struggle)?
- Sound Design & Mix Quality: can you hear the melody over the band? Did the student change an instrument (my first tip)?
- Documentation & Presentation: the Padlet questions, the Reflection page (page 24) and the presentation are the evidence.

REFLECTION · ADDED BY THIS KIT ·

The rubric mentions reflection, but the project sheet has no reflection task, so this kit adds one (page 24): a written or oral conversation about how you did on the project and what you would do differently next time. Students write it or talk it through with you; either way they answer the four prompts. Allow about 10 minutes after the presentations. It adds no points and no rubric row; use it as evidence when you score Documentation & Presentation.

NOTES / OBSERVATIONS ·

This is a great project for students who are less confident with playing but have strong arrangement ideas.

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SESSION PLAYER'S STUDIO

CHANGES

What changed from the original

Teacher

This kit is built from three of my documents: the **Project Sheet & Rubric**, the **Teacher Notes** and the **Session Player's Studio** entry on my DMP2 project menu. This page lists every change to my wording, so you know exactly what is mine and what was added.

WORDING CHANGES ·

- My LMS name is written as "your class page" (checklist items 1 and 2).
- Page numbers are added to steps 1 to 6 (the Players sheet, Chord cheat sheet, Arrangement plan, Melody planner and Mix sheet).
- Tip 2 says "Ask a search engine or an AI chatbot" where I named two products, because they are third-party names. No song, artist, site or link is named anywhere in the kit.
- My two YouTube resources are written as "a YouTube video on…" with no title, creator or link, because they are someone else's videos. Neither is included.
- My third resource, the common chord progressions cheat sheet, is supplied by this kit (page 13). It is made from music theory, in Roman numerals and five major keys, with no song named; it is a suggestion, not one of my sheets.
- My Easier variation (a given chord progression) and my More Advanced variation (an original progression, a B-section with a different groove and a live-recorded element) are laid out on page 10. No audio is included.
- My pacing guide's "Classes 3–5" row spans the Class 3, 4 and 5 rows, so each class can name its slides.
- Layout only: the rubric's Name and Date lines moved to the top; its Notes box became ruled lines.
- The intro deck shortens my wording (full wording on pages 18–20): slide 3 shortens my overview and goals, slide 6 shortens my five vocabulary definitions, slide 7 shortens steps 1 and 2, slide 9 shortens step 3 and tip 1, slide 11 shortens step 4 and my third struggle, slide 14 shortens step 5 and tip 4, slide 15 shortens step 6, slide 16 shortens the submission checklist, and slide 18 shortens step 7.
- **Reflection added (page 24).** My rubric mentions reflection, but the project sheet has no reflection task. This kit adds one, following my definition: a written or oral conversation about how the student did on the project and what they would do differently next time. It adds no points and no rubric row.

KEPT AS I WROTE IT ·

Everything else from my three documents is kept as I wrote it: the overview, goals, five vocabulary terms, five requirements, steps (apart from the page numbers), tips (apart from tip 2), checklist (apart from the class page) and file name ("Your Name – Session Player's Studio"), the /25 rubric, what the project reinforces, my four struggles, the variations, my pacing, my closing note and the project menu entry on page 3. No rubric row is added and the requirements are unchanged.

NEW IN THIS KIT ·

Everything else is new and supports my sheets without changing them: the how-to, overview and setup pages, the teacher moves in the pacing guide, the grading suggestions, the Logic quick reference, the Easier and Harder planning pages, the worked example (an invented 24-bar piece for three Session Players and a melody, with its chords, settings and sections, on paper, not audio), the Chord cheat sheet, Players sheet, Arrangement plan, Melody planner and Mix sheet, the vocabulary and presentation pages and the intro deck. None adds a requirement or a rubric row. The one addition that asks something of students is the Reflection page (page 24), explained under Wording changes; the rubric is unchanged.

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SESSION PLAYER'S STUDIO

Logic quick reference

SETUP

Teacher + student

Where to find the tools a Session Player's Studio project is likely to use. Demonstrate what your class needs on Classes 1 and 2 and then let students work. Names are from current Logic Pro versions; labels move between versions, so check yours.

New project and tracks	File › New…, then add tracks with Track › New Tracks…. Choose Drummer, then add a Bass Player and a Keyboard Player from the same menu.
Session Players	Each player has its own editor: choose a style, then set how loud or soft and how simple or complex it plays. Drummer also has groove and fill controls. The player creates the notes; you choose the sound.
Change the sound	In the Library, choose a different instrument or kit for a player (my first tip). The part stays; the sound changes.
Chords	Show Global Tracks (G) and use the Chord track to type in the chords, one a bar, so Bass Player and Keyboard Player follow them. Or let the Keyboard Player play from the chords you give it.
Tempo and length	Set the tempo in the control bar. Bars × 240 ÷ tempo = seconds; at 96 BPM, 24 bars is 60 seconds. The Arrangement plan has a length helper.
Sections	Add arrangement markers named Intro, Groove, B-section and Ending. In each section, change a player's complexity or mute it to vary the energy (my third struggle).
Your melody	Record a Software Instrument with a MIDI keyboard or the on-screen keyboard, or program notes in the Piano Roll. Keep to the chord tones on the strong beats (Melody planner).
Live-recorded element (Harder)	Add an Audio track and record a voice or an instrument through a microphone. Wear headphones so the band does not leak into the recording.
EQ, pan, plug-ins	Add Channel EQ for balance, use each track's Pan knob, and add effects such as a reverb. Press X for the Mixer.
Bounce and zip	File › Bounce › Project or Section (Command-B), MP3 or WAV. In Finder, Control-click the .logicx and choose Compress.

VERSION NOTE

Menu names are from current Logic Pro versions; older versions may differ slightly. Logic Pro is a trademark of Apple Inc., named only to describe what the project needs. This resource is not affiliated with Apple.

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SESSION PLAYER'S STUDIO

Easier and Harder variations

TEACHER

Easier + Harder

My Easier variation: provide a chord progression and let students focus on arrangement and melody. The progression below is the kit's own (it is not one of my sheets). Hand it out as is, or choose one from the Chord cheat sheet (page 13).

EASIER: A GIVEN CHORD PROGRESSION AND A PLAN TO FILL IN ·

GIVEN: KEY OF C, ONE CHORD A BAR, REPEAT			
C	**Am**	**F**	**G**
bar 1	bar 2	bar 3	bar 4

At 96 BPM, 24 bars = 60 seconds (length helper, page 15).

HOW TO USE IT

1. Load the three players and type the chords in.
2. Fill in the plan below: the bars, and which players play in each section.
3. Spend the saved time on the arrangement and the melody.

SECTION	BARS	WHICH PLAYERS, AND HOW BUSY
Intro		
Groove		
B-section		
Ending		

MORE ADVANCED: ORIGINAL CHORDS, A B-SECTION AND A LIVE-RECORDED ELEMENT ·

My More Advanced variation. Plan it here, then build it in Logic. No audio is included.

My original progression (the chords, one a bar): _____

My B-section groove (what changes on the Drummer and Bass): _____

My live-recorded element (what, where it plays, how I record it): _____

CHECK

- ☐ The B-section sounds different from the groove: I can name two things that changed.
- ☐ The live-recorded element is clear and does not fight the melody.
- ☐ I wrote the chords myself and can name each one.

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SESSION PLAYER'S STUDIO

EXAMPLE

Worked example · an invented piece

Teacher

An **invented piece, "Porch Light", described on paper**: no audio is included. Students' projects will differ. 24 bars at 96 BPM, three Session Players, four sections (page 1 of 2).

1 · A WEAK PLAN

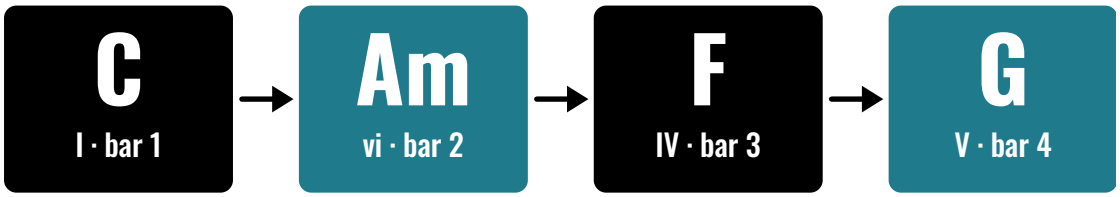
I will load three players and press play.

It names no chords, no settings and no sections.

2 · A CLEAR PLAN

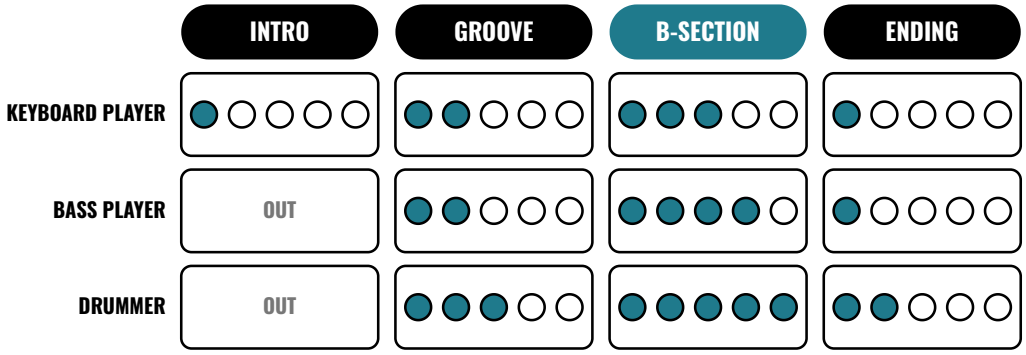
My piece is 24 bars at 96 BPM, which is 60 seconds, in the key of C. The chords are C, Am, F and G, and the B-section changes to F, G, C and Am. The Keyboard Player starts alone in the intro. The Bass Player and Drummer join at bar 5 for the groove. In the B-section the Drummer and Bass get busier and the groove changes. My melody comes in at bar 9 and uses chord tones. The ending thins out to a single C.

3 · THE CHORDS: A LOOP UNDER EVERY SECTION ·



Four bars, one chord each, then repeat. This is the loop under "Porch Light".

4 · THE SETTINGS: THE SAME PLAYERS, DIFFERENT COMPLEXITY ·



Complexity from 1 (simple) to 5 (busy), by section: an invented example

SECTION	BARS	WHAT HAPPENS
Intro	bars 1–4	Keyboard Player alone, simple (1); one chord a bar, C, Am, F, G
Groove	bars 5–12	Bass Player and Drummer join at bar 5; the same four chords twice; my melody joins at bar 9
B-section	bars 13–20	all three players busier (3, 4, 5); new chords F, G, C, Am twice; a fill at bar 12 leads in
Ending	bars 21–24	players thin out (1, 1, 2); F, G, then C for two bars; the melody ends on a held E in bar 23

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SESSION PLAYER'S STUDIO

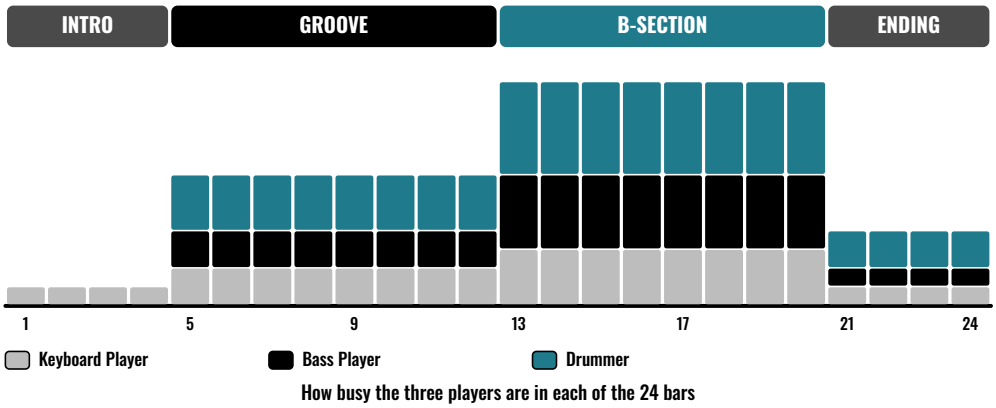
EXAMPLE

Worked example · the map

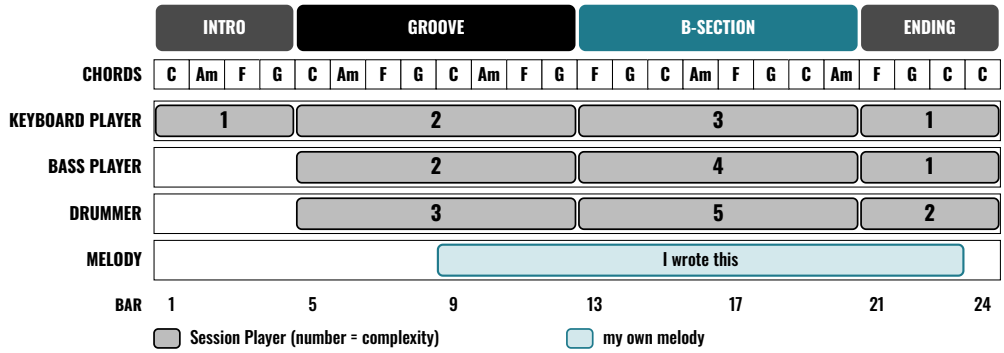
Teacher

"Porch Light", page 2 of 2: the energy, the map of the whole piece, then the numbers.

5 · THE ENERGY: HOW BUSY THE PLAYERS ARE IN EACH BAR ·



6 · THE MAP: FOUR SECTIONS, THREE PLAYERS, A MELODY ·



7 · WHAT I SET ON EACH PLAYER

Keyboard Player	I changed the sound from piano to a soft electric piano.	Style: gentle chords. Groove: straight and loose. Complexity: 1, then 2, then 3 in the B-section, then 1 again.
Bass Player	I kept a round electric bass.	Style: follows the chord roots. Groove: locked to the kick. Complexity: out for the intro, 2, then 4 in the B-section, then 1.
Drummer	I changed the kit to a soft, roomy one.	Style: a pop-rock beat. Groove: straight, slightly behind the beat. Complexity: out for the intro, 3, then 5 in the B-section with a fill at bar 12, then 2.

8 · THE CHORDS, BAR BY BAR

C 1	Am 2	F 3	G 4	C 5	Am 6	F 7	G 8	C 9	Am 10	F 11	G 12
F 13	G 14	C 15	Am 16	F 17	G 18	C 19	Am 20	F 21	G 22	C 23	C 24

9 · THE MELODY, TWO NOTES A BAR (BAR 9 ON)

C	E5 · G5	**Am**	E5 · C5	**F**	C5 · A4	**G**	B4 · D5

10 · CHECKING THE NUMBERS

One bar of 4/4 at 96 BPM lasts 240 ÷ 96 = 2.5 seconds, so 24 bars = 60 seconds, my "1 minute". The sections are 4 + 8 + 8 + 4 bars = 24. Bass notes are the chord roots (C2, A1, F1, G1). **Three Padlet questions (invented):** 1. Which player did you notice first, and when? 2. Where did the music feel biggest, and what made it feel that way? 3. What would you change in the melody so it stands out more?

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SESSION PLAYER'S STUDIO

Chord cheat sheet

STUDENT

Class 1

Name _____ Date _____

Step 2: choose a chord progression. Borrow one from a song you like or create your own. If chords intimidate you, start here. Each chord below is a major or minor chord that belongs to the key. Play one chord a bar, or two, and repeat. (This cheat sheet is the kit's own; it names no song.)

THE CHORDS IN FIVE MAJOR KEYS ·

KEY	I	II	III	IV	V	VI
C	C	Dm	Em	F	G	Am
G	G	Am	Bm	C	D	Em
D	D	Em	F#m	G	A	Bm
F	F	Gm	Am	Bb	C	Dm
A	A	Bm	C#m	D	E	F#m

Capital numerals are major chords; small numerals are minor. The same numeral is the same job in every key.

SIX COMMON PROGRESSIONS, IN EVERY KEY ·

PROGRESSION	FEEL	C	G	D	F	A
I – V – vi – IV	bright and open	C G Am F	G D Em C	D A Bm G	F C Dm Bb	A E F#m D
vi – IV – I – V	emotional, rising	Am F C G	Em C G D	Bm G D A	Dm Bb F C	F#m D A E
I – vi – IV – V	classic, nostalgic	C Am F G	G Em C D	D Bm G A	F Dm Bb C	A F#m D E
I – IV – V – I	simple and strong	C F G C	G C D G	D G A D	F Bb C F	A D E A
I – IV – vi – V	steady, warm	C F Am G	G C Em D	D G Bm A	F Bb Dm C	A D F#m E
ii – V – I	smooth, jazzy (3 chords)	Dm G C	Am D G	Em A D	Gm C F	Bm E A

TIPS

- A key you like is the one your melody sits in comfortably. Try two keys.
- Change the progression in your B-section for a lift.
- Want more? Ask a search engine or an AI chatbot for the chords to a song you like (tip 2).

CHECK

- ☐ I know the key and can name each chord.
- ☐ The chords are typed into my project, one a bar.

MY CHORDS (ONE A BAR)

My key: _____ **My progression is:** _____

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SESSION PLAYER'S STUDIO

Players sheet

STUDENT

Classes 1–2

Name _____ Date _____

Steps 1 and 3: load Drummer, Bass Player, and Keyboard Player, then adjust each session player's style, groove, and complexity settings. Don't be afraid to change the instrument a session player is using. It creates the notes, you choose the sound. Write what you set. Use 0 or "out" where a player is not playing.

DRUMMER

Sound I chose (did I change the instrument?): _____

Style: _____ **Groove (tight, loose, swinging):** _____

Complexity (1 simple to 5 busy): **Intro** _____ **Groove** _____ **B-section** _____ **Ending** _____

What I changed from the default, and why: _____

BASS PLAYER

Sound I chose (did I change the instrument?): _____

Style: _____ **Groove (how it sits with the drums):** _____

Complexity (1 simple to 5 busy): **Intro** _____ **Groove** _____ **B-section** _____ **Ending** _____

What I changed from the default, and why: _____

KEYBOARD PLAYER

Sound I chose (did I change the instrument?): _____

Style: _____ **Groove (how it plays the chords):** _____

Complexity (1 simple to 5 busy): **Intro** _____ **Groove** _____ **B-section** _____ **Ending** _____

What I changed from the default, and why: _____

CHECK

- ☐ At least 3 Session Players are loaded and none is left on its default settings.
- ☐ Complexity is different in at least two sections for every player.
- ☐ I changed at least one instrument sound.

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SESSION PLAYER'S STUDIO

STUDENT

Arrangement plan

Classes 2–5

Name _____ Date _____

Step 4: build an intro, main groove, and ending. Vary the energy between sections. Write the chord for each bar in the top row. Shade the bars where each player plays and write its complexity (1 to 5) in the shaded bars. Mark where each section starts. The intro should feel different from the peak.

Layer	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18	19	20	21	22	23	24	25	26	27	28	29	30	31	32	33	34	35	36
Chords																																				
Keyboard Player																																				
Bass Player																																				
Drummer																																				
My melody																																				

MY SECTIONS (INTRO · GROOVE · PEAK · ENDING)

Intro: _____ bars _____

Groove: _____ bars _____

B-section or peak: _____ bars _____

Ending: _____ bars _____

LENGTH HELPER (1 MINUTE)

BPM	BARS FOR 60 S	ONE BAR
80	20	3.00 s
96	24	2.50 s
100	25	2.40 s
120	30	2.00 s
128	32	1.88 s
144	36	1.67 s

My tempo: _____ **Bars:** _____ **Length: bars × 240 ÷ tempo =** _____ **seconds**

The peak is in bars _____ **because** _____

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SESSION PLAYER'S STUDIO

STUDENT

Melody planner

Class 4

Name _____ Date _____

Step 5: record or program an original melody over the top. The melody is what makes this yours. Spend real time on it. Plan a few bars here, then build them in Logic and keep changing them.

CHORD TONES IN C MAJOR (A NOTE FROM THE CHORD SOUNDS GOOD ON A STRONG BEAT)

C C E G	**Dm** D F A	**Em** E G B	**F** F A C	**G** G B D	**Am** A C E

IDEAS THAT WORK

- Start with a short idea of 3 or 4 notes and repeat it with a small change.
- Leave space. Rests make the melody easier to hear over the band.
- Change the melody in the B-section: higher, busier, or new notes.

CHECK

- ☐ My melody is my own: I wrote or played every note.
- ☐ The melody lands on a chord tone at the end.
- ☐ I can hear it over all three players.

BAR	CHORD	NOTES OR RHYTHM I PLAY	HOW IT FEELS

My melody starts in bar _____ **and plays on:** _____

The instrument sound I chose for it, and why: _____

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SESSION PLAYER'S STUDIO

STUDENT

Mix sheet

Classes 5–6

Name _____ Date _____

Step 6: balance levels, apply EQ and effects. Bounce your track. Write what you did on each track. Listen to the whole piece, then fix the one thing that bothers you most.

TRACK	LEVEL (LOUD · SOFT)	EQ AND EFFECTS I USED	WHAT I FIXED
Keyboard Player			
Bass Player			
Drummer			
My melody			

CHECKS BEFORE I BOUNCE

- ☐ I can hear my melody over the band, and the band still sounds like a band.
- ☐ No player is too loud, and the drums and bass sit together.
- ☐ EQ and at least one effect are in use.
- ☐ The intro, the groove and the peak all sound different.
- ☐ The piece is about 1 minute (give or take a few seconds).
- ☐ The bounce is named correctly and the project is zipped.

Close my eyes: the first thing I hear is _____

The part of my mix I am proudest of: _____

What I would fix with more time: _____

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Name _____ Date _____

SESSION PLAYER'S STUDIO

Digital Music Production | *Structured Project* | 7 class periods

OVERVIEW ·

Build a band without the band. Use Logic's Session Players — Drummer, Bass Player, and Keyboard Player — to create a realistic live-style arrangement. Customize their style, groove, and complexity, then add your own melody on top.

GOALS ·

- Learn to use Logic's Session Players (Drummer, Bass, Keyboard)
- Adjust style, groove, and complexity to create a realistic performance
- Arrange a short piece with an intro, groove, and ending
- Add an original melody and mix for a polished final product

KEY VOCABULARY ·

Session Player	A Logic Pro virtual musician that generates realistic performances based on your settings
Groove	The rhythmic feel of a performance — how tight, loose, or swinging it feels
Complexity	How busy or simple a session player's part is
Chord Progression	A sequence of chords that provides the harmonic foundation of a piece
Arrangement	How different sections and instruments are organized across the timeline

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SESSION PLAYER'S STUDIO

STUDENT

Project sheet · requirements and steps

Name _____ Date _____

REQUIREMENTS ·

- ☐ Load and customize at least 3 Session Players
- ☐ Adjust style, groove, and complexity for each player
- ☐ Arrange a short piece with a clear intro, groove section, and ending
- ☐ Add your own original melody over the top
- ☐ Mix and export a 1-minute live-style production

STEPS / PROCESS ·

1. **Set up** — Load Drummer, Bass Player, and Keyboard Player into your project (Players sheet: page 14)
2. **Choose a chord progression** — Borrow one from a song you like or create your own (Chord cheat sheet: page 13)
3. **Customize** — Adjust each session player's style, groove, and complexity settings (Players sheet: page 14)
4. **Arrange** — Build an intro, main groove, and ending. Vary the energy between sections. (Arrangement plan: page 15)
5. **Add your melody** — Record or program an original melody over the top (Melody planner: page 16)
6. **Mix and finalize** — Balance levels, apply EQ and effects. Bounce your track. (Mix sheet: page 17)
7. **Present & Get Feedback** — Create your own Padlet post with 3 questions you want classmates to answer about your project. Present to the class. During classmates' presentations, answer at least 2 of their 3 questions on their Padlet post.

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SESSION PLAYER'S STUDIO

STUDENT

Project sheet · tips and checklist

Name _____ Date _____

TIPS FOR SUCCESS ·

- Don't be afraid to change the instrument a session player is using. It creates the notes — you choose the sound.
- Need a chord progression? Ask a search engine or an AI chatbot for the chords to a song you like.
- Vary the complexity between sections. The intro should feel different from the peak.
- The melody is what makes this yours. Spend real time on it.

SUBMISSION CHECKLIST ·

- ☐ Bounced .mp3 or .wav uploaded to your class page
- ☐ Zipped .logicx project file uploaded to your class page
- ☐ Files named correctly: "Your Name – Session Player's Studio"
- ☐ At least 3 Session Players used with custom settings
- ☐ Padlet post created with your 3 feedback questions
- ☐ Answered at least 2 questions on classmates' Padlet posts during presentations

NOTES ·

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SESSION PLAYER'S STUDIO

RUBRIC

Rubric

/ 25

Name _____ Date _____

GRADING RUBRIC /25

Session Player's Studio | Structured Project

Each category is scored 1–5. Your final grade is the average of your self-score and your teacher's score.

Category	1	2	3	4	5
CREATIVITY & ORIGINALITY	Minimal creative effort; relies on defaults or clichés	Some creative ideas but largely predictable	Shows originality; experiments with sound or style	Highly creative; unique approach with clear artistic intent	Exceptional creativity; innovative, bold, and expressive
TECHNICAL SKILL / DAW USE	Limited understanding of Logic Pro tools	Basic tool use with frequent errors	Competent workflow; uses tools correctly	Advanced use of Logic features and shortcuts	Expert-level command of multiple Logic systems
COMPOSITION & STRUCTURE	Disorganized; no clear form or direction	Some structure present but underdeveloped	Clear, cohesive form with logical sections	Engaging structure with dynamic progression	Professional pacing, flow, and musical arc
SOUND DESIGN & MIX QUALITY	Poor sound choices; unbalanced or muddy mix	Some variety but inconsistent levels and EQ	Good sound selection; mostly balanced mix	Strong sound palette; clean, well-balanced mix	Exceptional sound design; professional-quality mix
DOCUMENTATION & PRESENTATION	Missing or incomplete; no reflection	Minimal documentation with little insight	Satisfactory; provides basic detail and reflection	Well-documented; clear and thoughtful reflection	Exceptional; thorough insight and polished delivery

Student Score: _____ / 25	Teacher Score: _____ / 25
Final Grade = Average of Student + Teacher = _____ / 25	

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SESSION PLAYER'S STUDIO

Key vocabulary

STUDENT

Vocabulary

Name _____ Date _____

The five words from your project sheet, with my definitions. Rewrite each in your own words, then show where it happens in your own project.

SESSION PLAYER — A Logic Pro virtual musician that generates realistic performances based on your settings

In my own words: _____

Where it shows up in my track: _____

GROOVE — The rhythmic feel of a performance — how tight, loose, or swinging it feels

In my own words: _____

Where it shows up in my track: _____

COMPLEXITY — How busy or simple a session player's part is

In my own words: _____

Where it shows up in my track: _____

CHORD PROGRESSION — A sequence of chords that provides the harmonic foundation of a piece

In my own words: _____

Where it shows up in my track: _____

ARRANGEMENT — How different sections and instruments are organized across the timeline

In my own words: _____

Where it shows up in my track: _____

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SESSION PLAYER'S STUDIO

Present and get feedback

STUDENT

Classes 6–7

Name _____ Date _____

FROM YOUR PROJECT SHEET, STEP 7

Present & Get Feedback — Create your own Padlet post with 3 questions you want classmates to answer about your project. Present to the class. During classmates' presentations, answer at least 2 of their 3 questions on their Padlet post.

MY THREE FEEDBACK QUESTIONS ·

Ask about things you really want to know, not yes-or-no questions.

Question 1: _____

Question 2: _____

Question 3: _____

CLASSMATES' QUESTIONS I ANSWERED (AT LEAST 2) ·

CLASSMATE	THEIR QUESTION	MY ANSWER

BEFORE I PRESENT ·

- ☐ Files named "Your Name – Session Player's Studio"; the .mp3 or .wav and zipped .logicx submitted
- ☐ At least 3 Session Players with custom settings (Players sheet, page 14)
- ☐ Padlet post created with my 3 questions
- ☐ Rubric self-score done (page 21)

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SESSION PLAYER'S STUDIO

Reflection · how did it go?

STUDENT

After presenting

Name _____ Date _____

WHAT A REFLECTION IS

A reflection is a written or oral conversation about how you did on the project and what you would do differently next time. Answer all four prompts in your own words. You choose how.

☐ **Written.** I will write my answers on this page.

☐ **Oral.** I will talk my answers through with my teacher. My teacher fills in the box at the bottom.

1 What went well? Name something in your project you are proud of, and say why it worked.

2 What did you struggle with? Say what was hard and what you tried to fix it.

3 What would you do differently next time? Be specific: a step, a choice, a sound or a tool.

4 Look at the rubric (page 21). Which category are you proudest of, and which would you work on first next time?

ORAL REFLECTION · TEACHER

Date: _____ **Prompts covered (1-4):** _____

Key points I heard: _____

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QUESTIONS?

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CREDITS

- Project sheet, rubric, teacher notes and intro deck: original work by Brian Lotze, Hudson Beat.
- Worked example (an invented 24-bar piece for three Session Players and a melody, with its chords, settings and sections, described on paper), the Chord cheat sheet (written from music theory), the hero, card, chord, settings, energy and arrangement drawings and layouts: original work, Hudson Beat.
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